

PhD Students Clubs Membership Charter

The PhD Students Club of the Engineering Digital Twins (EDT) programme brings together doctoral researchers working on digital twins across French institutions, whether or not their thesis is funded by EDT.

The Club is a space for scientific exchange, mutual support, and shared curiosity. This Charter sets out the spirit in which members engage with one another, and what joining the Club entails. Signing it opens access to the Club's seminars, annual Days, summer schools, and other EDT scientific events.

1. The spirit of this Charter

The EDT PhD students Club brings together the PhD candidates of the Engineering Digital Twins program, as well as any PhD student working in France on digital twins that registers and respects the EDT PhD students chart.

Its mission is to foster a vibrant scientific community, encourage peer exchanges, and support young researchers throughout their doctoral journey, despite the geographic dispersion of host teams. The club organizes monthly seminars, an annual day, and runs a space for sharing and mutual support open to all.

This Charter is not a contract. It is a shared agreement on the human and intellectual posture members adopt towards each other. Joining the Club means making this posture one's own.

2. Who can join

Membership is open to any PhD student enrolled in a French research institution and whose work bears on digital twins, broadly understood. **Funding by the EDT programme is not a requirement.**

Registration is made through the EDT website, with a short statement of motivation, confirmation of the PhD supervisor's approval and EDT Programm validation.

3. Six principles

These six principles together define the Club's culture. Members are expected to embody them in their interactions with one another.

Listening Pay genuine attention to other members' ideas, especially when they come from a discipline that is not your own. Ask before you respond.	Benevolence Critique the work, not the person. Assume good faith. Remember that PhD years are demanding, and that everyone is somewhere on their learning curve.	Sincerity Share honest thoughts, including doubts, dead ends, and ongoing uncertainties. The Club is a place where unfinished thinking is welcome.
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Confidentiality What is shared in Club exchanges stays within the Club, unless the speaker explicitly says otherwise. See the Chatham House Rule below.	Reciprocity The Club lives by what its members bring to it. Present your work, attend others' seminars, contribute to shared readings, welcome newcomers.	Curiosity Engage with approaches, methods, and questions that lie outside your immediate field. Cross-fertilisation is one of the main reasons the Club exists.
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4. What members do

Active membership is not merely passive attendance. It means showing up, contributing, and helping the Club live. Concretely, members are expected to :

- attend the Club's seminars whenever possible, and let others know in advance when they cannot;
- present their work to the Club during their PhD, at a stage they find appropriate;
- take part in EDT summer schools and scientific events;
- welcome newcomers, especially first-year PhD students, and help them find their bearings in the community;
- contribute to shared resources - readings, references, tools - when they prove useful to the wider group.

5. Confidentiality of exchanges

The Chatham House Rule applies to Club exchanges

Members are free to use the information they receive during a seminar or informal exchange, but may not reveal the identity nor the affiliation of the speaker, nor that of any other participant.

Recording, photography, or screenshots are taken only with the explicit consent of the speaker. When a seminar is recorded for the EDT CanalU channel, this is announced beforehand and members may opt out of being recorded.

6. Joining, staying, leaving

Membership lasts for the duration of the PhD. There is no formal renewal, but members who have been inactive for a long period may be contacted to confirm their wish to remain in the Club.

On completing their PhD, former members are warmly invited to join the Club's alumni mailing list, to keep in touch, attend public events, and occasionally come back to share their experience with current PhD students.

A member may leave the Club at any time, with no formality beyond informing the Club's coordinator.

7. Adhesion

Signing this Charter formalises adhesion to the Club's principles and opens access to its activities and to associated EDT events.